

Developer Tools Cheat Sheet

Quick Reference for Security Testing

Keyboard Shortcuts

Open Developer Tools

Action	Windows/Linux	Mac
Open DevTools	F12 or Ctrl+Shift+I	Cmd+Option+I
Open Console	Ctrl+Shift+J	Cmd+Option+J
Inspect Element	Ctrl+Shift+C	Cmd+Shift+C
Close DevTools	F12 or Esc	Cmd+Option+I

Navigate DevTools

Action	Shortcut
Switch Tabs	Ctrl+[or Ctrl+]
Search in Files	Ctrl+Shift+F
Search in Page	Ctrl+F
Clear Console	Ctrl+L
Refresh Page	Ctrl+R or F5
Hard Refresh	Ctrl+Shift+R

DevTools Tabs Quick Reference

1. Elements / Inspector Tab

What It Shows: HTML structure of the page

Use For:

- ☒ Finding CSRF tokens
- ☒ Checking XSS encoding
- ☒ Inspecting form elements
- ☒ Viewing HTML structure

Quick Actions:

- Ctrl+F - Search HTML

- Right-click element → Edit as HTML
 - Hover over element to highlight on page
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2. Console Tab

What It Shows: JavaScript errors and logs

Use For:

- ☒ Checking for error messages
- ☒ Testing JavaScript
- ☒ Viewing console logs
- ☒ Running JavaScript commands

Quick Actions:

- `Ctrl+L` - Clear console
- Type JavaScript and press Enter to run
- `console.log()` to test code

Useful Commands:

```
// Check if cookies are accessible
document.cookie

// Should return empty if HttpOnly is set
// If you see cookies, HttpOnly is NOT set ✕

// Test XSS
alert('test')

// Check current user
console.log(document.getElementById('user-info'))
```

3. Network Tab

What It Shows: All network requests

Use For:

- ☒ Checking HTTPS usage
- ☒ Viewing request/response headers
- ☒ Checking security headers
- ☒ Monitoring API calls

Quick Actions:

- `Ctrl+R` - Refresh to see requests

- Click request → Headers tab
- Filter by type (XHR, JS, CSS, etc.)
- Right-click → Copy as cURL

What to Look For:

- ☒ Protocol: h2 or https
- ☒ Status: 200, 301, 302 (not 500)
- ☒ Security Headers present
- ☒ Protocol: http (insecure)
- ☒ Passwords in URL

4. Application / Storage Tab

What It Shows: Cookies, storage, cache

Use For:

- ☒ Checking cookie security
- ☒ Viewing cookie properties
- ☒ Checking local storage
- ☒ Viewing session storage

Quick Actions:

- Expand Cookies → Select site
- Right-click cookie → Delete
- View cookie properties
- Clear all storage

Cookie Properties to Check:

- ☒ HttpOnly: ✓ (checked)
- ☒ Secure: ✓ (checked)
- ☒ SameSite: Lax or Strict
- ☒ Value: Encrypted (random text)
- ☒ HttpOnly: (empty)
- ☒ Secure: (empty)
- ☒ Value: Plain text

5. Sources / Debugger Tab

What It Shows: JavaScript source code

Use For:

- ☒ Viewing JavaScript files
- ☒ Setting breakpoints
- ☒ Debugging code
- ☒ Checking for exposed secrets

Quick Actions:

- **Ctrl+P** - Open file
- Click line number to set breakpoint
- **F8** - Resume execution
- **F10** - Step over

Security Testing Quick Guide

Test 1: Cookie Security (2 minutes)

1. Press F12
2. Click "Application" tab
3. Expand "Cookies"
4. Click your site URL
5. Find .AspNetCore.Identity.Application
6. Check: HttpOnly ✓, Secure ✓, SameSite: Lax
7. Screenshot ✓

Test 2: CSRF Token (2 minutes)

1. Press F12
2. Click "Elements" tab
3. Press Ctrl+F
4. Search: __RequestVerificationToken
5. Verify: type="hidden", value="[long string]"
6. Screenshot ✓

Test 3: XSS Protection (3 minutes)

1. Enter: `<script>alert('XSS')</script>` in form
2. Save form
3. Press F12
4. Click "Elements" tab
5. Find where script is displayed
6. Verify: `<script>` (encoded)
7. Screenshot ✓

Test 4: Network Security (2 minutes)

1. Press F12
2. Click "Network" tab
3. Press Ctrl+R to refresh
4. Check all requests show "https"
5. Click request → Headers
6. Verify security headers present
7. Screenshot ✓

Test 5: Console Errors (1 minute)

1. Press F12
2. Click "Console" tab
3. Try to access forbidden page
4. Check no sensitive info in errors
5. Screenshot ✓

Total Time: 10 minutes

What to Look For

☒ GOOD Signs (Security is Working)

Cookies:

- HttpOnly flag is checked ✓
- Secure flag is checked ✓
- SameSite is "Lax" or "Strict"
- Value is encrypted (random text)

Forms:

- `__RequestVerificationToken` present
- Token is hidden (type="hidden")
- Token value is long random string

HTML:

- Scripts are encoded (`<script>`)
- No executable JavaScript in user input
- HTML tags are escaped

Network:

- All requests use HTTPS

- Security headers present
- No passwords in URLs

Console:

- Generic error messages only
 - No stack traces
 - No database details
-

✗ BAD Signs (Security Issues)

Cookies:

- HttpOnly is NOT checked ✗
- Secure is NOT checked ✗
- SameSite is "None" ✗
- Value is plain text ✗

Forms:

- No CSRF token ✗
- Token is visible to users ✗
- Token is empty ✗

HTML:

- Scripts are NOT encoded (<script>) ✗
- JavaScript executes from user input ✗
- Alert popups appear ✗

Network:

- Some requests use HTTP ✗
- Missing security headers ✗
- Passwords visible in URLs ✗

Console:

- Database errors visible ✗
 - Stack traces shown ✗
 - File paths exposed ✗
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Screenshot Checklist

Cookie Security Screenshot Must Show:

- ☐ Application/Storage tab is open
- ☐ Cookies section is expanded
- ☐ Your website is selected

- ☐ Authentication cookie is visible
- ☐ HttpOnly column shows ✓
- ☐ Secure column shows ✓
- ☐ SameSite column shows "Lax"
- ☐ Value is encrypted (random text)

CSRF Token Screenshot Must Show:

- ☐ Elements/Inspector tab is open
- ☐ Form element is expanded
- ☐ `__RequestVerificationToken` input is visible
- ☐ `type="hidden"` is visible
- ☐ `value="[long string]"` is visible

XSS Protection Screenshot Must Show:

- ☐ Elements tab is open
- ☐ Script is encoded (`<script>`)
- ☐ Clear evidence of HTML encoding
- ☐ No executable script tags

Network Security Screenshot Must Show:

- ☐ Network tab is open
- ☐ Multiple requests visible
- ☐ Protocol column shows "h2" or "https"
- ☐ OR Headers tab showing security headers

Console Screenshot Must Show:

- ☐ Console tab is open
- ☐ Any error messages visible
- ☐ No sensitive information in errors
- ☐ Generic error messages only

Pro Tips

Tip 1: Use Element Picker

1. Click arrow icon (top-left of DevTools)
2. Hover over any element on page
3. Click to select it in Elements tab
4. Faster than searching manually!

Tip 2: Preserve Network Log

1. Open Network tab
2. Check "Preserve log" checkbox
3. Requests won't disappear on page reload

Tip 3: Filter Console Messages

1. Open Console tab
2. Click filter icon
3. Uncheck "Verbose" and "Info"
4. Only see important messages

Tip 4: Search Across All Files

1. Press Ctrl+Shift+F
2. Search for: `__RequestVerificationToken`
3. Finds token in all files

Tip 5: Copy Request as cURL

1. Open Network tab
2. Right-click any request
3. Copy → Copy as cURL
4. Paste in Postman or terminal

Troubleshooting

Problem: DevTools Won't Open

Solutions:

- Try **Ctrl+Shift+I** instead of F12
- Try right-click → Inspect
- Check if DevTools is disabled by admin
- Restart browser

Problem: Can't Find Application Tab

Solutions:

- In Firefox: Look for "Storage" tab
- In older browsers: Look for "Resources" tab
- Click >> icon to see more tabs

Problem: Cookies Not Showing

Solutions:

- Make sure you're logged in
- Refresh the page
- Check if cookies are enabled
- Clear browser cache and try again

Problem: Network Tab is Empty

Solutions:

- Refresh page (Ctrl+R)
- Check "Preserve log" checkbox
- Make sure you're on the right domain
- Clear and reload

Problem: Too Many Console Messages

Solutions:

- Click "Clear console" (trash icon)
- Use filters to hide info/verbose
- Focus on errors and warnings only

Browser Differences

Chrome DevTools

- Tab: "Application" for cookies
- Tab: "Elements" for HTML
- Most features available

Firefox DevTools

- Tab: "Storage" for cookies
- Tab: "Inspector" for HTML
- Similar to Chrome

Edge DevTools

- Same as Chrome (Chromium-based)
- Tab: "Application" for cookies
- Tab: "Elements" for HTML

☒ Quick Testing Workflow

Total Time: 10 minutes

1. Open website → Login
2. Press F12
3. Test cookies (Application tab) → Screenshot
4. Test CSRF (Elements tab) → Screenshot
5. Test XSS (Elements tab) → Screenshot
6. Test network (Network tab) → Screenshot
7. Test console (Console tab) → Screenshot
8. Done! ✓

Learning Resources

Chrome DevTools:

- Official Docs: <https://developer.chrome.com/docs/devtools/>
- Video Tutorial: Search "Chrome DevTools tutorial" on YouTube

Firefox DevTools:

- Official Docs: <https://firefox-source-docs.mozilla.org/devtools-user/>
- Video Tutorial: Search "Firefox DevTools tutorial" on YouTube

Security Testing:

- OWASP Testing Guide: <https://owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/>
- Web Security Academy: <https://portswigger.net/web-security>

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Difficulty: ★ Easy

Time Required: 10 minutes

Cost: FREE (Built into browser)